Josh Whitehead

AI Product Builder · ships daily with coding agents · fifteen years of product design

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SUMMARY

I design and build AI products end to end: prompts and context, grounding, measuring what the model actually shipped, streaming and agent interfaces, on-device inference, and the product around them, with coding agents in the loop every day. Underneath that is fifteen years of product design: first designer to Head of Design twice, both companies acquired, Apple and Google partnerships shipped. I want a team building AI-native products where designing and building are one job.

PROJECTS

- **Portrait.** Spotify Wrapped for your chat history. josh.design/lab/portrait
- **A model in your browser.** A language model running on your GPU through WebGPU. josh.design/lab/local
- **Whitehead City.** A GTA-style open world of my life, playable in the browser. josh.design/lab/city

EXPERIENCE

Founder & Design Lead

Boneyard Collective · Jan 2024 – Present · Los Angeles, CA

AI-native design and product studio. Client work for startups by day; our own AI products in between, designed and shipped end to end with coding agents in the loop every day.

- Design and ship AI products end to end: OLO (a desktop companion for the Mac), Weaver (a writing room that remembers a channel), StoryMode (game stories as audio), each live at its own site.
- Ship daily with coding agents (Claude Code, Codex): a typical day is 20 to 60 commits across 3 to 10 projects, measured from session logs rather than estimated.
- Built josh.design as a working AI-builder portfolio: a language model running in the browser on WebGPU, a hosted Claude grounded in the site's own text, five agent-interface prototypes, and a playable 3D city built with a coding agent in sixteen days.
- Incubated OLO, a personal-intelligence product: set the product vision, assembled a founding team from Meta, Calm, and Saucey, and took it from concept through design to investor readiness.

Head of Design

Spin (Ford Mobility) · May 2019 – Nov 2022 · joined as Senior Product Designer

First product designer at the micromobility company. Built the design function from zero and led it through partnerships with Apple and Google, then an acquisition.

- Joined as the first designer and became Head of Design; built and led a team of 10 across product design, brand, illustration, copy, and UX research.
- Designed the App Clips experience Apple featured at WWDC 2020 as a flagship iOS 14 use case (covered in Wired), working with Apple to refine the scooter rental flow for the launch.
- Led the Google Maps integration that put Spin vehicles on the map (August 2021): vehicle usage up 40%, new signups up 60%.

Director of Design

Hush (backed by Kleiner Perkins) · Mar 2017 – Jun 2019 · joined as Senior Product Designer

First product designer at a social-commerce startup. Owned the app, brand, and site, and rebuilt the product as it scaled past a million users.

- Built an internal influencer-batching tool that halved deal closure time and handled 100+ influencer contracts.
- Designed and shipped the company's first Android app, which grew to more than 30% of company revenue.
- Promoted to Director of Design: led a team of three, shaped the roadmap with leadership, and pitched investors directly. Hush was acquired.

Principal Product Designer

Very Good Ventures — client engagement · Nov 2022 – Dec 2023

Principal designer at the leading Flutter studio. Designed a Flutter design system adopted across VGV and Google teams, and a generative-AI game shown at Google I/O 2023.

- Contributed concepts and gameplay QA to I/O FLIP, the generative-AI card game shown at Google I/O 2023, with Google teams.
- Turned client requirements into flows and prototypes, paired with engineering, and mentored designers across engagements from startups to Google.

Lead Product Designer

Saucey · Oct 2015 – Feb 2017

- Owned all design at an on-demand delivery startup: consumer apps, driver experience, partner tools, internal operations, and marketing.
- Designed internal routing software (99.9% uptime) that cut order-status support tickets by more than 90%.

Senior Designer

NationBuilder · Nov 2014 – Sep 2015

- Built 10+ customizable templates for campaigns, nonprofits, and community organizations, and the look and feel for the CEO's book launch, site, and merchandise.

Designer & Front-End Developer

Differential (studio) · Nov 2013 – Oct 2014

- First designer at an engineering-first studio; helped take 10+ startups from concept to launch across e-commerce, health, and finance, as the sole design resource and de facto product manager.

SKILLS

AI & models · LLM product design, Prompt and context engineering, Grounding / RAG-style retrieval, Streaming UI for model output, On-device inference (WebGPU, WebLLM), Agent interaction design (progress, permissions, failure, confidence), Agentic development with Claude Code and Codex, Anthropic SDK, Evals: measuring shipped model output against a spec, Generative video pipelines (Veo), Agent workflows across many projects

Engineering · TypeScript, React, Next.js, Tailwind, Three.js / React Three Fiber, GLSL shaders, Flutter

Product design · 0→1 product design, Design systems, Brand, Mobile (iOS, Android, Flutter), Web, Design leadership, Partnerships (Apple, Google)

Tools · Figma, Framer, ProtoPie, Sketch, Claude Code, Codex, Vercel, GitHub

PUBLICATIONS

Mastery is Dead: The Quiet Collapse of Expertise. A field manual for the collapse of expertise: how AI is restructuring twenty-five white-collar careers, what survives, what doesn't, and what to do if you work in one. 618 pages, paperback. masteryisdead.com

EDUCATION

Career school, digital design. Film, photography, code, music, games. Fine art in college (charcoal and canvas) before enlisting.

United States Marine Corps, 2008 – 2013. Combat photographer.